PANZER 2600

GAME PROGRAM™ INSTRUCTIONS

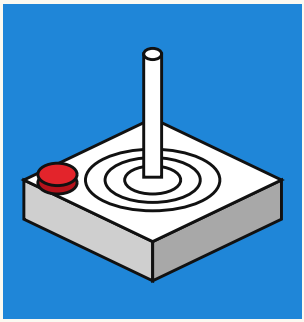


ATARI®

A Homebrew Game Program for the ATARI® Video Computer System™

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Use your two Joystick Controllers with this ATARI® Game Program.™ Be sure both Controllers are firmly plugged into the **LEFT CONTROLLER** and **RIGHT CONTROLLER** jacks at the rear of your ATARI Video Computer System.™ Player 1 uses the left Controller; Player 2 uses the right. Hold each Controller with the red button to your upper left toward the television screen. See Section 3 of your Owner's Manual for further details.



Note: Always turn the console power switch OFF when inserting or removing an ATARI Game Program. This will protect the electronic components and prolong the life of your ATARI Video Computer System.

Note: For more enjoyment of the PANZER 2600 Game Program, please read all instructions carefully before beginning play. Keep this instruction booklet handy for quick reference.

HOW TO PLAY



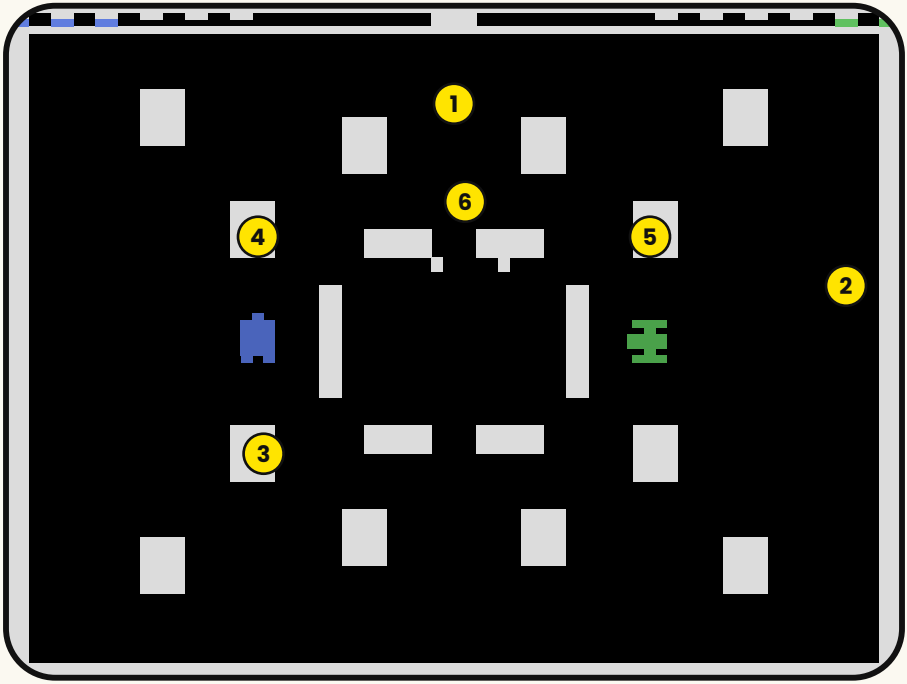
Two enemy tanks have been sent into the same walled arena—and only one is coming out. Drive your Panzer, aim your turret, and fire a single devastating shell. Hit your opponent before they hit you. The first tank to score **five hits** wins the battle.

This is no easy task. Your cannon cannot be fired on the spur of the moment: every shell must be **charged** by holding down the red button for three full seconds, and while you charge, your tank grinds slowly to a halt. Worse, shells **ricochet**—and a bounced shell can come right back and hit the tank that fired it.

Choose from eight different arenas, from open fields to a walled maze. Each one changes the way the battle is fought.

THE BATTLEFIELD

Every battle takes place inside a walled arena. Player 1's blue tank begins on the left side of the screen and Player 2's green tank on the right. Tanks cannot drive through walls or obstacles, and they cannot leave the arena.



1. **SCORE BOXES.** Each player has five boxes along the top. A box fills with that player's color for every hit scored.
2. **ARENA WALLS.** They surround the battlefield. Tanks stop at them; shells bounce off.
3. **OBSTACLES.** Every arena has its own layout of barriers (see THE ARENAS).
4. **PLAYER 1** (blue). Starts on the left, facing up.
5. **PLAYER 2** (green). Starts on the right, facing left.
6. **SHELL.** A small gray dot that flies in a straight line.

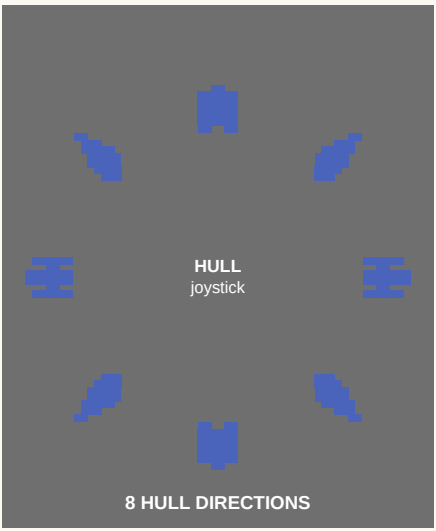
USING THE CONTROLLER

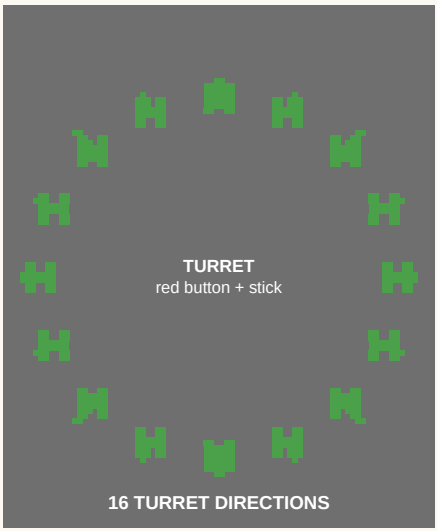
Your tank has two moving parts: the **HULL** (the body and tracks) and the **TURRET** (the gun). Each is controlled separately.

Driving. Push the joystick **forward** to drive in the direction the hull is facing. Pull it **back** to reverse. Let go to stop.

Turning the hull. Push the joystick **left** or **right** to rotate the hull one step at a time. There are eight directions. Hold the stick over to keep turning; a full circle takes a little under one second.

Aiming the turret. Hold down the **red button** and push left or right. The turret swings in sixteen steps—twice as fine as the hull—and points wherever you like, no matter which way the tank is facing.



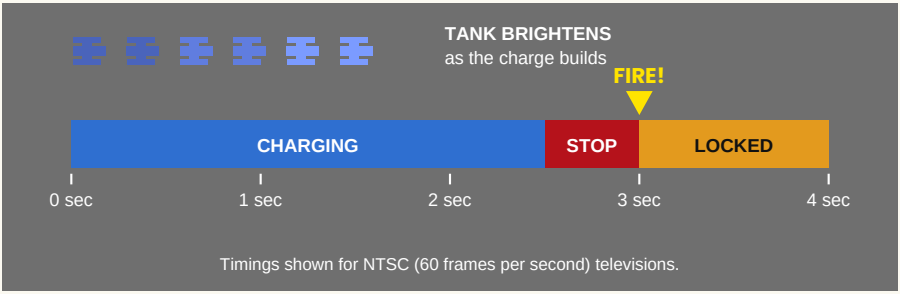


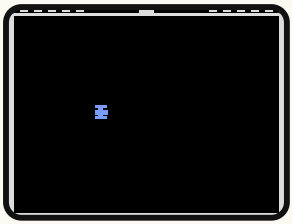
Note: The Controller repeats automatically while you hold it, so there is no need to tap. A full turn of the turret takes about one and a half seconds, so line up your aim early.

THE CHARGED SHOT

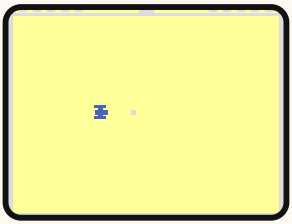
There is no rapid fire in PANZER 2600. Your cannon is powerful—and slow. To fire, hold down the **red button** and keep your turret still.

- While you hold the button, a charge builds. Your tank slowly **brightens** as the charge grows, so you can always see how close a tank is to firing—yours or your opponent's.
- You may keep driving while you charge, but the heavier the charge, the slower you go. In the last half second your tank **stops dead**.
- After **three seconds** the shell fires by itself. You do not need to let go of the button.
- Release the button early, or turn the turret, and the charge is lost.
- Firing kicks the tank backward and flashes the screen. For **one full second** afterward your tank is **locked**—no driving, no turning.
- Each tank may have only one shell in the air at a time. A fully charged tank holds its fire until its last shell is gone.
- You must release the button before you can start a new charge.

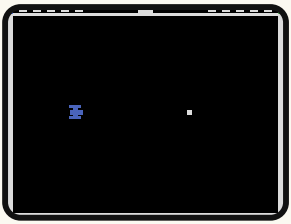




1. CHARGING



2. FIRE! (screen flash)



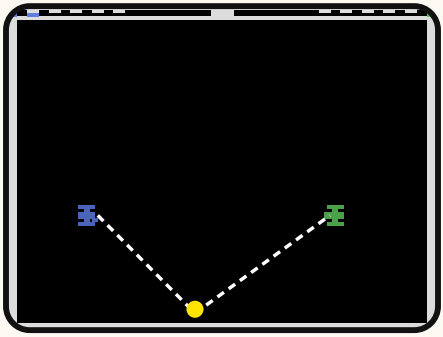
3. KICK-BACK

RICOCHETS AND HITS

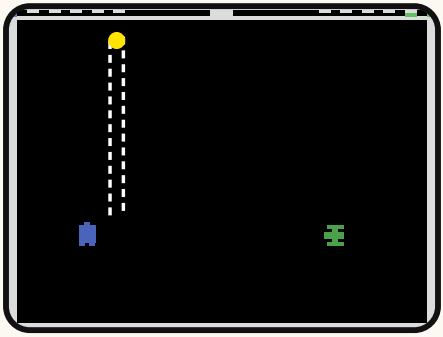
A shell flies in a straight line in the direction your turret points. It is fast—it can cross the whole screen in well under a second.

When a shell strikes a wall or an obstacle, it **bounces** off like a billiard ball. Each shell can bounce **twice**. The third time it touches a wall, it is destroyed.

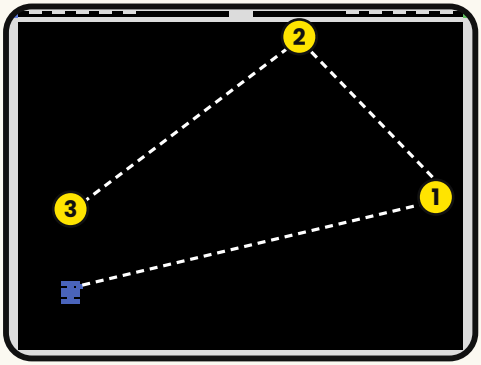
WARNING: Once a shell has bounced, it is dangerous to *everyone*—including the tank that fired it. A tank hit by its own ricochet scores a point for its opponent!



BANK SHOT. Bounce a shell off a wall to reach a tank that is out of sight.



OUCH! A shot straight at a wall comes straight back at you.



1st and 2nd contact: bounce. 3rd contact: gone.

Hits. A shell that touches any part of a tank destroys it. The destroyed tank vanishes and the other player scores a point.

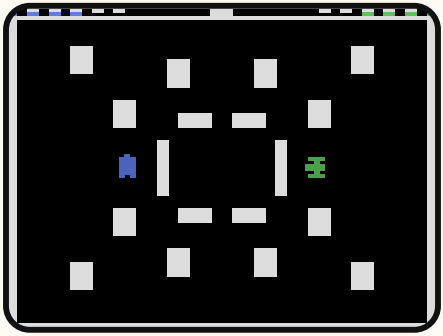
Shells pass through each other. When both tanks have a shell in the air, the shells flicker. This is normal—the VCS can show only one at a time.

STARTING THE GAME

Turn the console power switch ON. The PANZER 2600 title screen appears with a flashing bar beneath it. Either player may press the **red button** to continue.



TITLE SCREEN



ARENA SELECT (Arena 3)

Choose your arena. Push either joystick **left** or **right** to cycle through the eight arenas. The score boxes show which arena is selected—three boxes on each side means Arena 3. Press the red button on either Controller to begin the battle.

After a one-second pause, the first round begins. The arena stays the same for the whole battle.

When a battle ends, the game returns to the title screen. Press the red button to choose an arena and play again.

CONSOLE CONTROLS

The **game select**, **game reset**, **difficulty** and **TV type** switches are not used by this Game Program. To start over at any time, turn the console power switch OFF and then back ON.

SCORING AND WINNING

Each time a shell hits a tank, the other player scores **one point** and a box fills in at the top of the screen. The destroyed tank vanishes. After a pause of one and a half seconds, both tanks return to their starting positions for the next round.



START OF BATTLE



PLAYER 1 LEADS, 3 TO 1

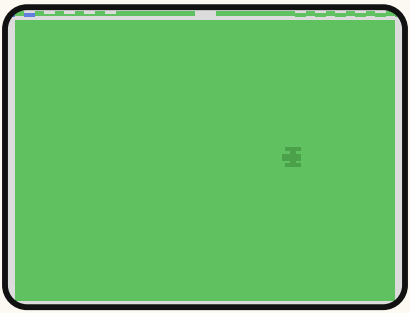


PLAYER 2 LEADS, 4 TO 2

The first player to score **five points** wins the battle. The screen then flashes in the winner's color—**blue** for Player 1, **green** for Player 2—for about four seconds before the game returns to the title screen.



PLAYER 1 WINS!

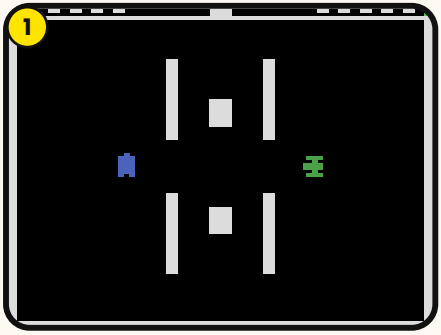


PLAYER 2 WINS!

Note: A tank hit by its own ricochet gives the point to its opponent—so even a brilliant bank shot can lose you the battle.

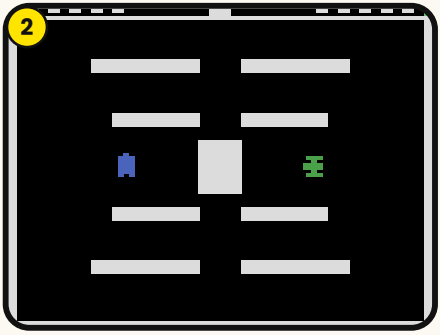
THE ARENAS

PANZER 2600 offers eight arenas. Choose yours on the title screen by pushing the joystick left or right. Each arena is mirrored left-to-right and top-to-bottom, so neither player has the advantage.



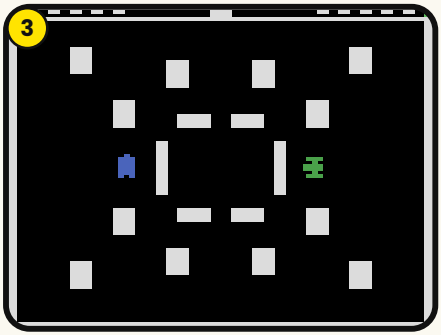
BRIDGES

Two long barriers either side of center, with small blocks in the middle. Open lanes run above and below. A good first arena.



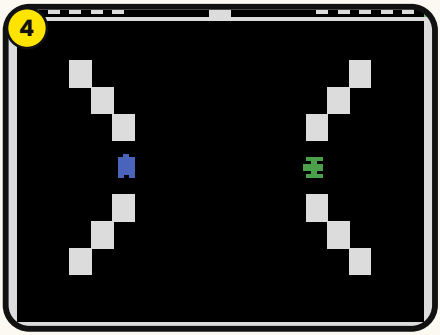
SHELVES

Wide horizontal shelves stacked above and below the center. The gaps at the sides are the only way around —and the best places to ambush.



ISLANDS

Scattered blocks and short walls. Plenty of cover, and plenty of odd angles for ricochets.



CHEVRON

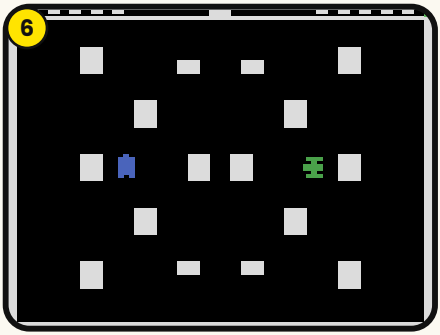
Stair-step diagonal walls slope in from the sides. Shells bounce at sharp angles off the slopes.

THE ARENAS (CONTINUED)



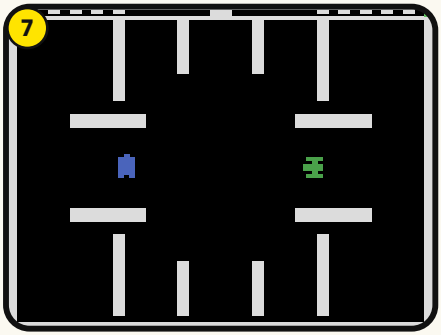
THE BOX

A walled box with open sides sits in the center. Use it for cover, or bank shots off its edges.



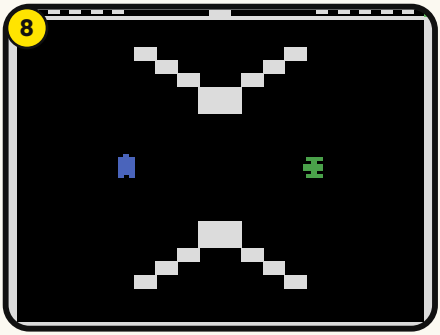
PILLARS

Little square pillars dotted around the field. Easy to hide behind—hard to predict where a shell goes.



THE MAZE

Tall walls form corridors at the top and bottom, with short bars flanking the center. Think before you charge: you will be standing still.



THE X

Diagonal barriers cross at the center to form a giant X. Steer clear of the middle—or use it as cover.

BATTLE TIPS

- **Watch the color.** A brightening tank is a tank about to fire. When your opponent glows, get out of the line of fire—or behind a wall.
- **Charge from cover.** You will be slow, then frozen. Start your charge where the opponent can't easily reach you.
- **Aim first, then charge.** Turning the turret wipes out your charge, so point the cannon before you press and hold.
- **Bank it.** A shell has two bounces. Shooting off a wall lets you hit a tank hiding behind an obstacle.
- **Beware your own ricochet.** After its first bounce, your shell can hit you. Never fire straight at a nearby wall.
- **Expect the kick.** Firing shoves your tank backward, opposite the turret, then locks you in place for a second. Make sure you're not drifting into the line of fire.
- **Outlast the shell.** Right after you fire, you cannot move. Time your shot for when the opponent is busy charging.

QUICK REFERENCE

Drive forward	Push joystick forward
Reverse	Pull joystick back
Turn hull	Push joystick left / right
Turn turret	Hold red button + push left / right
Charge and fire	Hold red button 3 seconds
Choose arena	Push left / right on title screen
Begin battle	Press red button

3 sec	1 sec	2	5	8 / 16
to charge a shot	locked after firing	bounces per shell	points to win	hull / turret directions

PANZER 2600

TWO-PLAYER TANK COMBAT



Two tanks. One arena. Hold the red button, take aim, and let a charged shell fly—but remember that every wall is a mirror. First to five hits wins.

PROGRAM FEATURES

- Two players, two Joystick Controllers
- Eight mirrored battle arenas
- Eight-way hull and sixteen-way turret
- Charge-and-release cannon with recoil
- Double-bounce ricochet shells
- First to five hits wins the battle

PROGRAM INFORMATION

Written in 6502 assembly language for the ATARI® 2600 Video Computer System™. Designed for NTSC televisions and two Joystick Controllers. Fits a standard 4K Game Program cartridge.

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